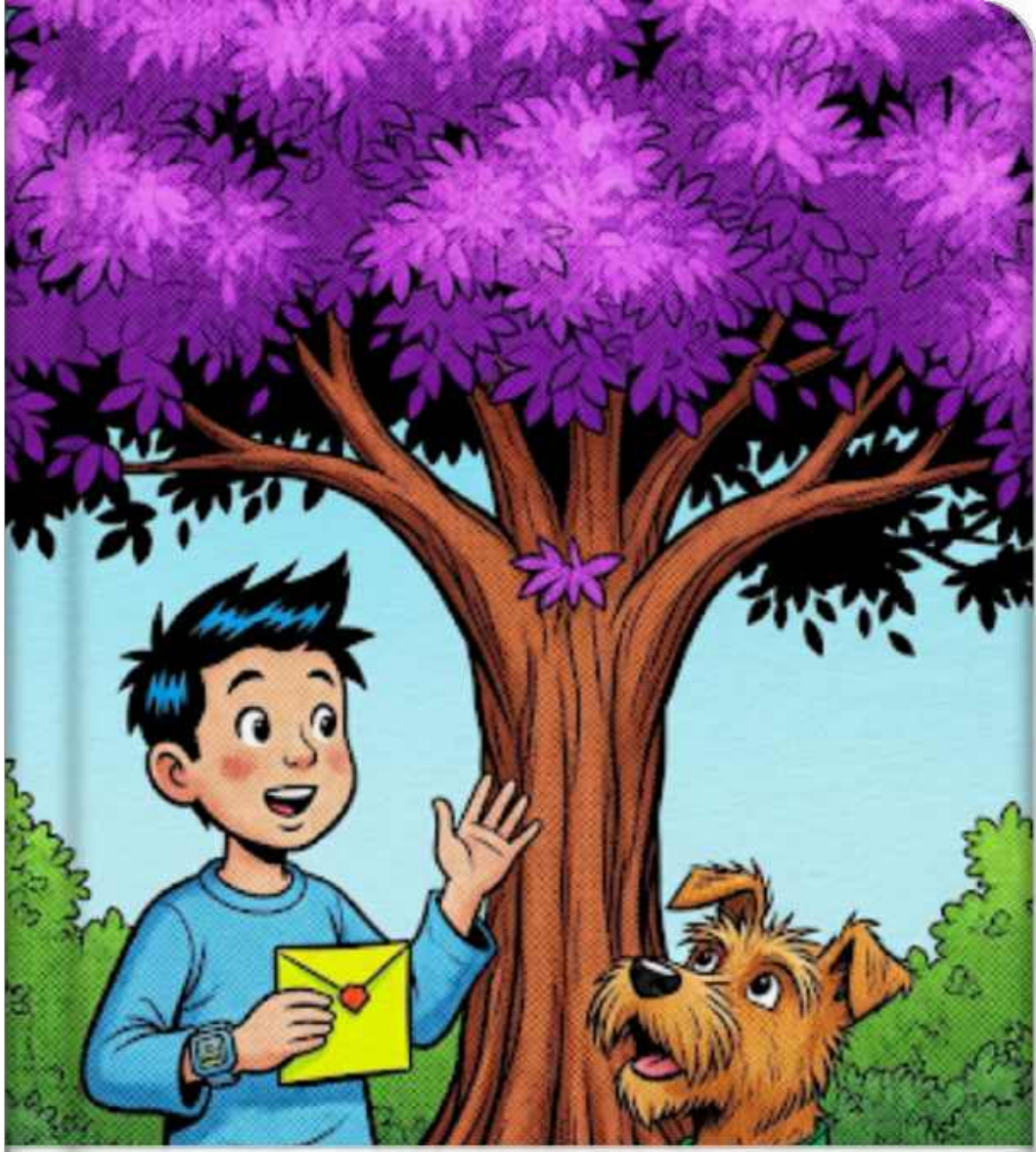

The Day of the Great Zing

By Kshipra

It was a very ordinary Tuesday until Zap opened his eyes. He expected to see his plain white ceiling, but instead, he saw a bright, neon-yellow envelope stuck right above his head! His heart gave a little jump. "What in the world?"

Zap scrambled out of bed and called for his best friend, a bouncy dog named Whiz. Whiz came skidding into the room, his paws sliding on the wooden floor. Zap pointed to the ceiling. "How do we get it down, Whiz?" Whiz

Whiz didn't wait. He leaped onto the bed and gave a mighty "Woof!" The force of his bounce shook the bed, and the yellow envelope fluttered down like a falling leaf. Whiz tried to catch it in his mouth, but he missed and landed in a

Zap picked up the envelope. Inside was a single piece of paper that said: "Look for the Zigzag!" Suddenly, a shadow stretched across the floor. It wasn't a straight shadow; it was shaped like a giant, jagged bolt of lightning. "The

The zigzag shadow led them out into the backyard. But the backyard wasn't the same as it was yesterday. Right in the middle of the grass stood a tree with bright purple leaves. Zap stopped so fast he almost tripped. "That

Whiz ran ahead to the purple tree. He sniffed the trunk and then nudged a low-hanging branch with his nose. DING! The branch made a sound like a tiny silver bell. Whiz jumped back, his ears flopping forward in confusion. He tilted his

Zap joined Whiz at the tree. He saw a small, golden handle hidden among the purple leaves. He looked at Whiz, and Whiz looked at Zap. "Should we?" Zap asked. With a deep breath, he pulled the handle. A secret door in the tree trunk

Zap stepped through the door and let out a huge "Gasp!" Inside the tree, gravity seemed to have gone on vacation. Everything was floating! Zap's feet left the ground, and he began to drift upward like a balloon. "Whiz, look! I'm flying!" He

Eventually, the mist cleared, and Zap found himself sitting on his back porch again with Whiz snoring at his feet. The purple tree was gone, but Zap felt warm and tingly inside. He realized that surprises were like magic seeds planted in